

# ALEXANDER GURUNG

+1 703-835-1897 | [aag1234@gmail.com](mailto:aag1234@gmail.com) | [github.com/alex-gurung](https://github.com/alex-gurung) | US & UK Dual Citizen

## EDUCATION

### University of Edinburgh

PhD in ILCC: Language Processing, Speech Technology, Information Retrieval, Cognition  
Supervised by Mirella Lapata and Esmeralda S. Whitamner Malkin, expected graduation 2026

Edinburgh, UK  
Aug. 2023 – Present

### Georgia Institute of Technology

Master of Science in Computer Science, Concentration in Machine Learning

Atlanta, GA  
Aug. 2020 – Dec. 2022

### Georgia Institute of Technology

Bachelor of Science in Computer Science, Minor in Linguistics

Atlanta, GA  
Aug. 2018 – Dec. 2020

## RESEARCH INTERESTS

I'm currently working on efficient Reinforcement Learning for long-story generation and understanding, and am especially interested in creative and long-horizon reasoning for challenging and hard-to-verify domains.

## RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

### University of Edinburgh

PhD Candidate

Edinburgh, UK  
Aug. 2023 – Present

- Working on efficient and creative RL for long-narrative tasks, code, and deep-research
- Designed lightweight latent reasoning paradigm integrating RL (TACL 2026)
- Proposed new RL paradigm for book-chapter generation (COLM 2025)

### ServiceNow - RL for Agentic Reasoning (RLAR)

Visiting Researcher

London, UK  
Dec. 2025 – Present

- Exploring dense credit assignment for privacy-aware deep-research agents

### Social and Language Technologies (SALT) Group @ Georgia Tech

Researcher

Atlanta, GA  
Jan. 2020 – May 2023

- Investigated the processes and distribution of radicalization on alt. social media
- Analysed prevalence of political frames using dependency-parsing system

### Meta AI

AI Resident - ParLAI Team

New York City, NY  
Aug. 2021 – Sep. 2022

- Improved LLM generalization in predicting text-game world-state changes

### Electro-Optical Systems Laboratory @ Georgia Tech Research Institute

Machine Learning Graduate Research Assistant

Atlanta, GA  
Jan. 2021 – May 2021

- Expanded genetic programming framework's capabilities for images

## WORK EXPERIENCE

### University of Edinburgh

Teaching Assistant @ Foundations of NLP

Edinburgh, UK  
Dec. 2024 – May 2025

- Designing course materials for undergraduate NLP course
- Creating coding and theory assignments for sentiment analysis and translation

### TikTok

Machine Learning Engineer Intern - Trust & Safety Team

Mountain View, CA  
Jun. 2021 – Aug. 2021

- Designed MoE neural architectures to improve region-specific auto-moderation performance
- Deployed models to production and showed improvements in performance over time

## PUBLICATIONS

### MosaicLeaks: Privacy Risks in Querying-in-the-Open for Deep Research Agents

Alexander Gurung, Spandana Gella, Alexandre Drouin, Issam H. Laradji, Perouz Taslakian, Rafael Pardinias

Submitted 2026

### Lightweight Latent Reasoning for Narrative Tasks

Alexander Gurung, Esmeralda S. Whitamner, Mirella Lapata

TACL 2026

### Long-Context Reasoning Through Proxy-Based Chain-of-Thought Tuning

Miao Li, Irina Saparina, Alexander Gurung, Mirella Lapata

ACL, 2026

### Who Gets Cited Most? Benchmarking Long-Context Numerical Reasoning on Scientific Articles

Miao Li, Alexander Gurung, Irina Saparina, Mirella Lapata

Submitted, 2026

### Learning to Reason for Long-Form Story Generation

Alexander Gurung, Mirella Lapata

COLM, 2025

### CHIRON: Rich Character Representations in Long-Form Narratives

Alexander Gurung, Mirella Lapata

EMNLP Findings, 2024